Writing Companies into Existence

Center Study Research and Design Syllabus, Fall 2026

Two sessions on Zoom · 15 & 22 November 2026

1 Introduction

> *Center Study and Anthropomorphics are two sides of the same coin and have a kind of Möbius strip character, or a relationship like that between the duck and the rabbit in the drawing that drew Wittgenstein's attention. If you do "enough" Center Study you'll find yourself anthropomorphizing, and vice versa.*
>
> Dennis Bouvard, "Anthropomorphics" [1]

This reading and writing group will oscillate between Center Study and Anthropomorphics: between research and design, between reading and writing, between discovery and creation, between hypothesis and practice. The group itself should become a tentative model for the kind of thinking, products, projects, and writing that Center Study and Anthropomorphics can generate.

The group is meant as a model of practice: an attempt to forge a new disciplinary space grounded in the idioms of Center Study, with a specific skew toward the creation and maintenance of *sovereign companies*, that is, companies that will ultimately become clients of a single sovereign data-security monopoly.

The seminar culminates in a writing project: each participant proposes at least one new company. Each is a sovereign company, one that addresses an "issue" in the social order and in doing so mends, fortifies, and profitably maintains sovereignty.

2 Preparation

We will be working with the vocabulary of *Mining the Gaps* [2], which is required reading before the first session. Participants are also expected to be familiar with Dennis Bouvard's *Anthropomorphics: An Originary Grammar of the Center* [3] and with the Substack archive at the Center Study Center [4].

3 Schedule of Readings

Session	Date	Reading	Author
1	15 November	Data Exchange [6]	Bouvard (2023)
		Learncoin [7]	Bouvard (2024)
2	22 November	Thirdness [8]	Bouvard (2023)
		Nomos/Class Action [9]	Bouvard (2024)

4 The Proposal

> *[T]hey must first be located in companies adjunct to the government (central intelligence) which are in the business of converting assets into data, i.e., mapping out the existing credit system for the sake of simulation and prediction. There's nothing more important, and really nothing else than, imagining and building such companies.*
>
> Dennis Bouvard, "Credit and Succession" [5]

Participants will propose companies that draw on specialized databases, search engines and AIs. The point is to make company creation a habit: if you identify a social "problem," or desideratum, your observation only gains credit if a company can be built to address it. It shifts discourse completely away from "rights" and building "coalitions" to petition governments, etc. It changes political language. If someone says, "but what do we do about the NGOs"—Ok, what kind of company could neutralize the NGOs (perhaps through lawsuits, perhaps through exposure of funding links and donors, etc.)? And then there would be companies generating new ideas for companies, maybe for prospective investors.

For source material, see *On Companies* [10]: 850 passages on companies drawn from 284 Center Study texts, sorted by theme, including data security, monopoly, and starting companies.

A Note on Vocabulary

Center Study is full of new vocabulary and idioms that will be unfamiliar at first. When you meet one, consult the Center Study glossary [11] or use the search at center.study.

RSVP

If you are able to accept this invitation, please complete the form at tally.so/r/gba7l1.

References

[1] D. Bouvard. "Anthropomorphics." Substack. https://dennisbouvard.substack.com/p/anthropomorphics

[2] *Mining the Gaps*. Notion. https://app.notion.com/p/Mining-the-Gaps-99110453eed540bb94af6e88274be7c8?pvs=25

[3] D. Bouvard. *Anthropomorphics: An Originary Grammar of the Center*. 2020. https://amazon.com/dp/0648690571

[4] Center Study Center. Substack archive. https://center.study/browse/substack

[5] D. Bouvard. "Credit and Succession." Center Study Center, 31 August 2025. https://center.study/post/credit-and-succession

[6] D. Bouvard. "Data Exchange." Center Study Center, 23 September 2023. https://center.study/post/data-exchange

[7] D. Bouvard. "Learncoin." Center Study Center, 21 March 2024. https://center.study/post/learncoin

[8] D. Bouvard. "Thirdness." Center Study Center, 2 December 2023. https://center.study/post/thirdness

[9] D. Bouvard. "Nomos/Class Action." Center Study Center, 12 September 2024. https://center.study/post/nomos-class-action

[10] Center Study Center. *On Companies*. https://center.study/companies

[11] Center Study Center. Glossary. https://center.study/concepts/glossary